

LEARNING HUB

Premium English Learning Resources

# English Pronunciation & Shadowing Practice

Stress • Rhythm • Linking • Intonation • Fluency

TEENS & ADULTS • ESL • SPEAKING PRACTICE

SOUND

SHADOW



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02

## Start here

A quick route from notice → practise → speak

### YOUR LEARNING MAP

# Use the workbook in short, repeatable sessions.

You can work alone, with a tutor, or with a speaking partner. Choose one page at a time rather than trying to finish everything in one sitting.

|             |            |               |            |              |
|-------------|------------|---------------|------------|--------------|
| 1<br>Notice | 2<br>Learn | 3<br>Practise | 4<br>Speak | 5<br>Reflect |
|-------------|------------|---------------|------------|--------------|

### 1 • Notice

Read the model language. Circle a phrase you could use this week.

### 2 • Learn

Say key phrases aloud. Focus on meaning before speed.

### 3 • Practise

Complete the guided task. Change one detail to make it yours.

### 4 • Speak

Use the role-play cards. Try once with notes, then once without.

### Quick win

Aim for one useful phrase you can actually say in real life today. Small, repeated practice beats one long session.

## VOCABULARY THAT DOES A JOB

# Learn the phrase, then make it personal.

Tip: do not memorize isolated words only. Notice the whole phrase, the situation, and one example sentence.

| Word / phrase   | Meaning                                | Model sentence                   | Practice note                     |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| word stress     | making one syllable more prominent     | PREsent (noun) vs preSENT (verb) | Notice the stressed syllable.     |
| sentence stress | highlighting important words           | I NEED the REPORT today.         | Content words often carry stress. |
| linking         | joining sounds across words            | pick_it_up                       | Aim for smooth connected speech.  |
| intonation      | the rise and fall of your voice        | Really? ↗ / Really. ↘            | Meaning can change.               |
| chunk           | a short group of words spoken together | Could you / send it / by Friday? | Pause by meaning.                 |
| shadowing       | speaking along with a model            | Listen → start → speak with it.  | Build rhythm and automaticity.    |
| contrast        | two sounds/words that differ           | ship / sheep                     | Listen for the key difference.    |
| pace            | how quickly you speak                  | Slow, clear, then natural.       | Clarity first.                    |

## Speak it!

Choose three phrases. Say each one with a different detail: person, place, time or reason.

04

## Conversation model

Notice how the speakers keep the exchange moving

A CONVERSATION YOU CAN BORROW

**Read once for meaning. Read again aloud. Then swap one detail.**

A

Could you read this sentence once naturally?

B

Sure: I **NEED** the **REPORT** by **FRIDAY**.

A

Good. Which words did you stress?

B

Need, report and Friday. They carry the key information.

A

Now link the words smoothly.

B

I need the report by Friday.

### Notice & borrow

Underline one phrase that keeps the conversation moving (for example: "How about you?"). Write your own version below.

05

## Guided practice

Build your answer before you speak

### SENTENCE FRAMES

**Complete the frame, then say the whole sentence aloud.**

01

The stressed word is \_\_\_\_.

02

I will link \_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_.

03

The key information is \_\_\_\_.

04

My voice rises/falls because \_\_\_\_.

05

I will pause after \_\_\_\_.

Your version:

## QUICK-CHECK CHALLENGE

**Try it without looking back at the vocabulary page.**

| Match | Term / concept  | Meaning                        |
|-------|-----------------|--------------------------------|
| 1     | linking         | A. voice movement              |
| 2     | intonation      | B. connected words             |
| 3     | chunk           | C. meaningful word group       |
| 4     | sentence stress | D. emphasis on key information |

**Upgrade it**

Take one basic sentence you could say and make it more natural by adding a reason, time, contrast or follow-up question.

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## REAL-WORLD SPEAKING PROMPTS

**For tutoring: give one card to each learner. For self-study: set a 60–90 second timer.**

**CARD 01 • Shadow round**

Shadow a sentence three times, focusing on rhythm.

Challenge: ask one follow-up question.

**CARD 02 • Stress shift**

Change the stressed word and explain how the meaning changes.

Challenge: ask one follow-up question.

**CARD 03 • Link it**

Read a phrase without stopping between every word.

Challenge: ask one follow-up question.

**CARD 04 • Intonation check**

Say one sentence as a question and as a statement.

Challenge: ask one follow-up question.



## PRONUNCIATION LAB

# Listen → notice → repeat → record → compare.

**Word stress**

PHOtograph / phoTOGraphy / photoGRAPHic

Try: Say each word three times. Tap the stressed syllable.

**Long vs short vowels**

ship / sheep • live / leave • full / fool

Try: Stretch the long vowel; keep the short vowel brief.

**TH sounds**

think / this / three / those

Try: Place the tongue lightly between the teeth and keep the sound clear.

**Final sounds**

worked / wanted / played / watched

Try: Do not drop the final sound. Read slowly, then naturally.

**Sentence stress**

I NEED the REPORT by FRIDAY.

Try: Stress the key information, then reduce less important words.

**Linking**

pick\_it\_up • turn\_it\_off • take\_a\_look

Try: Connect the words smoothly without adding extra pauses.

### Intonation

Are you ready? ↗ / I'm ready. ↘

Try: Use rising intonation for a yes/no question and falling intonation for a statement.

### Chunking

Could you / send the file / by tomorrow?

Try: Pause by meaning, not after every word.

## SHADOWING SCORECARD

**Record your own performance rather than aiming for perfection.**

| Round | What I focused on   | Clarity 1–5 | Rhythm 1–5 | Confidence 1–5 |
|-------|---------------------|-------------|------------|----------------|
| 1     | Listening + copying |             |            |                |
| 2     | Stress + linking    |             |            |                |
| 3     | Natural pace        |             |            |                |

**Before / after**

Round 1: clear but slow → Round 3: smoother and more connected. Your goal is noticeable improvement, not a perfect accent.

**What changed between your first and third attempt?**

## THE 3-LEVEL CHALLENGE

## Repeat the same task three ways.

**LEVEL 1 • Clear**

Give a short answer using one target phrase.

**LEVEL 2 • Natural**

Add a reason, example or follow-up question.

**LEVEL 3 • Flexible**

Respond to an unexpected change or disagreement.

### Your challenge prompt

**GO**

60–90 seconds • 1 target phrase • 1 follow-up question • 1 natural repair phrase if you get stuck

**Your speech is clear but choppy. Shadow one sentence again, focusing on linking and chunking.**

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## MINI REVIEW QUIZ

**Try first. Then check the answer key at the end.**

1

Choose the more natural phrase: "Repeat." / "Could you say that again, please?"

Answer:

2

Complete: "It \_\_\_ on the situation." (depends / dependent)

Answer:

3

What should you do when you do not understand? Name one polite repair phrase.

Answer:

4

Add a follow-up question to: "I prefer studying in the morning."

Answer:

5

Use one target phrase in a sentence about your own life.

Answer:

6

Give one reason for your opinion on a familiar topic.

Answer: \_\_\_\_\_

## CHECK &amp; IMPROVE

## Use the key to notice patterns, not just to score yourself.

| Task              | Suggested answer                                                                  |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Matching activity | 1-D, 2-B, 3-C, 4-A                                                                |
| Mini review 1     | B – the polite request is more natural.                                           |
| Mini review 2     | A – “It depends on...” is the natural phrase.                                     |
| Mini review 3     | Examples: “Could you say that again, please?” / “I’m afraid I didn’t catch that.” |
| Mini review 4     | Example: “How about you?”                                                         |
| Mini review 5–6   | Answers vary. Strong answers use a target phrase and a clear reason.              |

**Tutor note**

For speaking tasks, prioritize meaning, intelligibility and useful language. Correct only the errors that matter most for the learner’s goal.

## MY PRACTICE TRACKER

**Tick a box each time you complete a focused practice round.**

| Skill            | Round 1 | Round 2 | Round 3 | Notes |
|------------------|---------|---------|---------|-------|
| Vocabulary       |         |         |         |       |
| Guided speaking  |         |         |         |       |
| Independent task |         |         |         |       |
| Challenge mode   |         |         |         |       |

**Confidence check**

- ☐ I can start a conversation without overthinking.
- ☐ I can ask for clarification politely.
- ☐ I can use new vocabulary in a real sentence.
- ☐ I can keep speaking when I need more time.

**One skill I want to improve next:**

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## Thank you

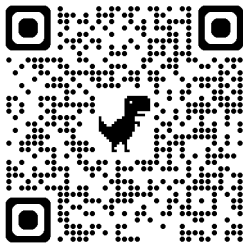
A little practice, used often, goes a long way.

### THANK YOU FOR CHOOSING LEARNING HUB

We hope this resource makes English practice feel more practical, focused and enjoyable.

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### SAVE THIS PAGE

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